

Complete Theme

Vocabulary — 23 words

Word	IPA	Turkish	Example
hardship <i>noun</i>	/ˈhɑːrdʃɪp/	zorluk, sıkıntı	The family faced many hardships after losing their farm.
struggle <i>verb</i>	/ˈstrʌɡl/	mücadele etmek	She struggled to pay the bills while she was studying at night.
overcome <i>verb</i>	/ˌoʊvərˈkʌm/	üstesinden gelmek, aşmak	He overcame his fear of public speaking by practising every day.
poverty <i>noun</i>	/ˈpɒvərti/	yoksulluk	They grew up in poverty in a small village.
determined <i>adjective</i>	/dɪˈtɜːrmd/	kararlı	She was determined to finish school despite the difficulties at home.
persevere <i>verb</i>	/ˌpɜːrsəˈvɪər/	azimle devam etmek	He persevered with his studies even when things were hard.
obstacle <i>noun</i>	/ˈɒbstəkl/	engel	Money was the biggest obstacle standing between her and university.
childhood <i>noun</i>	/ˈtʃaɪldhʊd/	çocukluk	During his childhood, the family moved from town to town looking for work.
homeless <i>adjective</i>	/ˈhoumləs/	evsiz	For a short time, they were homeless and stayed with relatives.
sacrifice <i>verb</i>	/ˈsækrɪfaɪs/	fedakarlık yapmak	Her parents sacrificed a lot so that she could go to school.
courage <i>noun</i>	/ˈkʌrɪdʒ/	cesaret	It took a lot of courage to start a new life in another city.
exhausted <i>adjective</i>	/ɪgˈzɔːstɪd/	bitkin, yorgun	She was exhausted after working two jobs to support her family.
survive <i>verb</i>	/sərˈvaɪv/	hayatta kalmak, atlatmak	The family survived a difficult winter with very little food.
achievement <i>noun</i>	/əˈtʃiːvmənt/	başarı	Finishing university was his greatest achievement.
support <i>noun/verb</i>	/səˈpɔːrt/	destek / desteklemek	Her neighbours supported her when her family was struggling.
inspire <i>verb</i>	/ɪnˈspaɪər/	ilham vermek	His story inspired other students to keep trying.

Word	IPA	Turkish	Example
AbOnlinEnglish Upper Secondary — 11. Sınıf — Complete Theme : Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.			
failure <i>noun</i>	/ˈfeɪljər/	başarısızlık	He didn't see failure as the end, just as a lesson.
resilient <i>adjective</i>	/rɪˈzɪliənt/	dirençli, azimli	Children can be surprisingly resilient after difficult experiences.
background <i>noun</i>	/ˈbækgraʊnd/	geçmiş, köken	Despite her difficult background, she became a respected teacher.
opportunity <i>noun</i>	/ˌɒpər ˈtjuːnəti/	fırsat	A scholarship gave him the opportunity to study abroad.
journey <i>noun</i>	/ˈdʒɜːni/	yolculuk (mecazi anlamda süreç)	Her journey from a small village to a university degree wasn't easy.
income <i>noun</i>	/ˈɪnkʌm/	gelir	The family had very little income after the factory closed.
reflect <i>verb</i>	/rɪˈflekt/	düşünmek, üzerinde durmak	Now she often reflects on how far she has come.

Past Simple

We use the past simple for finished actions or situations at a definite time in the past. Regular verbs add -ed; many common verbs are irregular.

Geçmişte belirli bir zamanda tamamlanmış eylemler veya durumlar için past simple kullanılır. Düzenli fiillere -ed eklenir; birçok yaygın fiil ise düzensizdir.

When? Use it for a single finished action, a series of finished actions, or a past state that is now over.

Tek bir tamamlanmış eylem, art arda gelen tamamlanmış eylemler veya artık bitmiş bir geçmiş durum için kullanılır.

Positive

- Subject + V2 (regular: verb + -ed)
- She worked hard.
- They moved to a new city.

Negative

- Subject + didn't + base verb
- She didn't give up.
- They didn't have much money.

Question

- Did + subject + base verb...?
- Did she work hard?
- Did they move to a new city?

Short answers

- Yes, she did. / No, she didn't.
- Yes, they did. / No, they didn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~She not worked hard.~~ → **She didn't work hard.**
- ~~Did she moved to the city?~~ → **Did she move to the city?**
- ~~He goed to school every day.~~ → **He went to school every day.**

1. When she was a child, her family _____ (not have) a car.

2. Which sentence is correct?

- a. She study every night.
- b. She studied every night.
- c. She studying every night.
- d. She studies every night ago.

3. _____ they move to a bigger house last year? (question)

4. He didn't gave up on his dream. — *True / False*

5. Put the words in order: hard / worked / two / jobs / she

6. Rewrite in the negative: They had enough money.

7. Choose the correct irregular past form of 'lose'.

- AbOnlinEnglish Upper Secondary — 11. Sınıf — Complete Theme · Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.
- a. losed
 - b. lost
 - c. loses
 - d. losing

8. Despite the hardship, the family _____ (survive) together.

9. Turn into a question: She finished school at 18.

10. Put the words in order: overcome / the / difficult / he / years / most

Past Continuous (and Past Continuous with 'while')

We use the past continuous (was/were + verb-ing) for an action in progress at a specific moment in the past, or for two actions happening at the same time, often linked with 'while'.

Past continuous (was/were + fiil-ing), geçmişte belirli bir anda devam eden bir eylem için veya genellikle 'while' ile bağlanan, aynı anda gerçekleşen iki eylem için kullanılır.

When? Use it for background actions in progress, actions interrupted by another action (with past simple), or two parallel actions with 'while'.

Devam etmekte olan arka plan eylemleri, başka bir eylem tarafından kesilen eylemler (past simple ile birlikte) veya 'while' ile ifade edilen iki paralel eylem için kullanılır.

Positive

- Subject + was/were + verb-ing
- She was studying at night.
- They were working long hours.

Negative

- Subject + wasn't/weren't + verb-ing
- He wasn't earning much.
- They weren't sleeping well.

Question

- Was/Were + subject + verb-ing...?
- Was she studying?
- Were they working long hours?

Short answers

- Yes, she was. / No, she wasn't.
- Yes, they were. / No, they weren't.

Common mistakes

- ~~She was study when the phone rang.~~ → **She was studying when the phone rang.**
- ~~While she was studying, her mother cooked.~~ → **While she was studying, her mother was cooking.**
- ~~They was working hard.~~ → **They were working hard.**

1. At 9 p.m. last night, she _____ (write) her homework.

2. While his parents were working, he _____ his younger brothers.

- a. look after
- b. was looking after
- c. looked after
- d. looking after

3. _____ you _____ (sleep) when the storm started?

4. They were not sleeping well during that period. — *True / False*

AbOnlinEnglish Upper Secondary — 11. Sınıf — Complete Theme · Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.

5. Put the words in order: was / while / studying / she / working / her / brother / was

6. Combine using 'while': He was cooking. His sister was cleaning.

7. While the family _____ (struggle) financially, neighbours _____ (bring) them food.

8. Put the words in order: doing / were / arrived / letter / what / the / when / you

Used to

We use 'used to' + base verb to talk about repeated past habits or past states that are no longer true.

'Used to' + fiilin yalın hali, artık doğru olmayan tekrarlanan geçmiş alışkanlıkları veya geçmiş durumları anlatmak için kullanılır.

When? Use it to contrast a past habit/state with the present situation. Do not use it for a single, one-time action.

Geçmişteki bir alışkanlığı/durumu şimdiki durumla karşılaştırmak için kullanılır. Tek seferlik bir eylem için kullanılmaz.

Positive

- Subject + used to + base verb
- He used to walk to school.
- They used to live in a village.

Negative

- Subject + didn't use to + base verb
- She didn't use to eat meat.
- We didn't use to have a car.

Question

- Did + subject + use to + base verb...?
- Did he use to walk to school?
- Did they use to live in a village?

Short answers

- Yes, he did. / No, he didn't.
- Yes, they did. / No, they didn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~He use to walk to school.~~ → **He used to walk to school.**
- ~~She didn't used to eat meat.~~ → **She didn't use to eat meat.**
- ~~I used to go to the cinema yesterday.~~ → **I went to the cinema yesterday.**

1. They _____ (live) in a small village before they moved to the city.

2. Which is correct?

- a. She didn't used to smile much.
- b. She didn't use to smile much.
- c. She not used to smile much.
- d. She use to not smile much.

3. _____ you _____ (play) outside all day when you were a child?

4. He use to work in a shoe factory. — *True / False*

5. Rewrite using 'used to': In the past, she had very little money.

6. Put the words in order: school / walk / to / used / he / to

7. We _____ (not have) enough food during the hardest years, but things are better now.

AbOnlinEnglish Upper Secondary — 11. Sınıf — Complete Theme · Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.

8. Explain the difference: 'I used to go to that school' vs 'I went to that school yesterday'.

The Girl Who Didn't Stop

Before you read

- Look at the title. What do you think 'didn't stop' might mean here?
- Have you ever heard a true story about someone who overcame a difficult childhood?

Elif grew up in a small town where her family didn't have much money. Her father worked long hours at a local workshop, and her mother sold vegetables at the market. When Elif was ten years old, her father lost his job, and things became even harder. The family moved into a smaller house, and Elif started helping her mother at the market every morning before school.

While her classmates were playing after school, Elif was usually working or studying by candlelight, because the electricity at home was often cut off. She used to dream about becoming a teacher one day, but nobody in her family had ever finished university. Many people told her it wasn't realistic for a girl from her background.

Elif didn't listen to them. She studied every night, even when she was exhausted, and she never missed a day of school. One teacher noticed how determined she was and began giving her extra books to read. Slowly, Elif's grades improved, and after years of hard work, she won a scholarship to study education at a university in another city.

Today, Elif is a teacher at a school not far from the town where she grew up. She often tells her students that hard times don't have to decide who you become. 'I used to think poverty would stop me,' she says, 'but it actually taught me how to keep going.' Her story has since inspired several of her own students to keep studying, no matter how difficult their situation is.

1. What was the main obstacle in Elif's early life?
 - a. She was ill for many years.
 - b. Her family had very little money.
 - c. She didn't like school.
 - d. She lived far from her family.
2. Elif used to help her mother at the _____ every morning.
3. Elif's family had electricity all the time. — *True / False*
4. What helped Elif improve her grades?
 - a. Moving to a bigger house
 - b. Her father's new job
 - c. A teacher who gave her extra books
 - d. Stopping work at the market
5. Elif won a _____ to study education at university.

6. According to Elif, what did poverty actually teach her?

- AbOnlineEnglish Upper Secondary — 11. Sınıf — Complete Theme · Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.
- a. To give up early
 - b. How to keep going
 - c. To avoid school
 - d. To depend on others

After you read

- Do you agree that hard times can teach us something useful? Why or why not?
- What would you say to a friend who feels like giving up during a difficult time?

From the Repair Shop to the Stage

Before you read

- What jobs do you know that require working with your hands?
- Do you think it's possible to follow a dream while working a difficult job?

Kerem's father used to run a small bicycle repair shop, and Kerem started helping him there when he was only eleven. While other children in the neighbourhood were going to after-school clubs, Kerem was fixing tyres and cleaning chains. The family needed the extra income, so there wasn't much time left for hobbies.

One rainy afternoon, while Kerem was repairing an old guitar that a customer had left behind, he started playing a few notes just to test the strings. He had never had lessons, but something about the sound stayed with him. From that day, whenever the shop was quiet, he practised on that same guitar, teaching himself simple songs from an old book his uncle had given him.

Life didn't get easier quickly. Kerem still worked at the shop every afternoon, and money was often tight at home. But he used to save a little money from small jobs to buy guitar strings, and he never stopped practising, even during the hardest months when the shop had almost no customers.

Years later, a local café owner heard Kerem playing outside the repair shop and asked him to perform one evening. That first small concert led to others, and slowly Kerem built a name for himself as a musician in his city. He still visits the repair shop sometimes, not to fix bicycles, but to remind himself where his journey began.

1. What was Kerem's family business?

- a. A music shop
- b. A bicycle repair shop
- c. A café
- d. A bookshop

2. Kerem first started playing an old _____ that a customer had left.

3. Kerem had professional guitar lessons from the start. — True / False

4. How did Kerem get his first chance to perform?

- a. He entered a competition.
- b. A café owner heard him playing outside the shop.
- c. His uncle organised a concert.
- d. He advertised online.

5. Kerem used to save money from small jobs to buy guitar _____.

After you read

AbOnlinEnglish Upper Secondary — 11. Sınıf — Complete Theme · Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.

- What does this story suggest about combining work and following a passion?
- Do you know someone who kept a hobby going during a difficult time? Tell your partner about it.

A Conversation About Hard Times

Before you listen

- What kinds of hard times might a family go through?
 - Predict: what do you think these two speakers will talk about?
1. Why did speaker A's family move house so often?
 - a. They liked new places.
 - b. Their house was too small.
 - c. The father kept losing his job.
 - d. They wanted to be near school.
 2. Speaker A was studying for exams while the family was _____ boxes.
 3. No one helped speaker A with school. — *True / False*
 4. What did speaker A used to do while other students went home?
 - a. Go home early too
 - b. Stay late for extra help
 - c. Play sports
 - d. Work part-time
 5. How does speaker A feel about that period now?
 - a. Still angry about it
 - b. Thinks it taught them to adapt quickly
 - c. Doesn't want to talk about it
 - d. Wishes it never happened

My Family's Story

Pairs · 8-10 min

Interview your partner about a difficult time someone in their family (or an invented family, if they prefer) went through, using past simple and past continuous questions.

Useful language: What was happening when...?, How did your family deal with...?, While this was happening, what were you/they doing?, In the end, they managed to...

1. Think of a hard time (real or invented) that a family member went through.
2. Prepare 4-5 questions to ask your partner about their story, using past simple and past continuous.
3. Take turns interviewing each other and taking short notes.
4. Report your partner's story back to the class in 3-4 sentences.

Then and Now

Groups of 3-4 · 8-10 min

Discuss habits and routines that used to be common in the past (in general, or in your own family/town) but have changed today.

Useful language: People used to..., We didn't use to..., Nowadays, people..., Things have changed because...

1. In groups, brainstorm 5 things people used to do in the past that are different now.
2. Discuss why you think these habits changed.
3. Choose the most interesting example and prepare to share it with the class.
4. Present your example, using 'used to' at least twice.

Writing

A Short Biography: Overcoming a Hard Time

120-150 words

Write a short biographical paragraph about a person (real or invented) who faced a hardship and overcame it. Use past simple, past continuous, and 'used to' at least once each.

Plan:

1. Decide who your subject is and what hardship they faced.
2. List 2-3 key events in the order they happened.
3. Note one thing the person 'used to' do or have that later changed.
4. Think of a sentence describing two things happening at the same time (with 'while').

Checklist:

- ☐ Did I use the past simple correctly for finished events?
- ☐ Did I use the past continuous correctly, including at least one 'while' sentence?
- ☐ Did I use 'used to' correctly for a past habit or state?
- ☐ Did I use at least 3 topic words from the vocabulary list?
- ☐ Is my paragraph within the word limit and organised clearly?

Diary Entry: A Hard Day

100-130 words

Write a diary entry from the point of view of a person living through a difficult period, describing what was happening and what you used to do differently before.

Plan:

1. Choose a specific day and situation to write about.
2. Decide what was happening around the writer at that time.
3. Think of one thing the writer used to do before life became difficult.
4. Add a short reflection at the end about how the writer feels.

Checklist:

- ☐ Is my diary entry written in the first person?
- ☐ Did I include at least one past continuous sentence?
- ☐ Did I include at least one 'used to' sentence?
- ☐ Did I use appropriate topic vocabulary?
- ☐ Does my entry have a clear beginning, middle, and end?

1. When he was young, his family _____ (not have) much money.
2. Which word means 'to deal successfully with a difficulty'?
 - a. struggle
 - b. overcome
 - c. sacrifice
 - d. reflect
3. While she _____ (study), her brother was cleaning the house.
4. He use to work in his uncle's shop. — *True / False*
5. In the reading 'The Girl Who Didn't Stop', what did Elif win?
 - a. A job
 - b. A scholarship
 - c. A prize for writing
 - d. A house
6. _____ you _____ (sleep) when the phone rang last night?
7. In the listening, why did speaker A's family move so often?
 - a. They liked travelling.
 - b. The father kept losing his job.
 - c. Their house was too small.
 - d. They wanted a bigger garden.
8. Rewrite with 'used to': In the past, they lived in a small village.
9. Put the words in order: overcame / hardship / she / great / a
10. Which sentence correctly combines two past continuous actions?
 - a. While he was working, she studied.
 - b. While he worked, she was studying.
 - c. While he was working, she was studying.
 - d. While he working, she was studying.

Support

1. Write 4 sentences about your own daily routine now, using 'I used to...' for something you did differently as a young child.
2. Match 6 vocabulary words from this theme to their Turkish meanings.
3. Complete 5 gap-fill sentences with the past simple form of common irregular verbs (go, have, lose, leave, find).
4. Listen again to the conversation and write down 3 things speaker A used to do.

Core

1. Write a short paragraph (80-100 words) about a difficult time in your own life or a family member's life, using past simple and past continuous.
2. Write 5 original sentences with 'used to' about habits that have changed in your family or neighbourhood.
3. Choose 8 vocabulary words from this theme and write an original sentence for each.
4. Interview a family member about a hard time they experienced and note down 3 key facts to share in class.

Extension

1. Write a 150-word biographical text about someone (real or invented) who overcame a serious hardship, using all 3 grammar points from this theme.
2. Research a real public figure known for overcoming hardship and write a short summary of their story in your own words, without copying any source directly.
3. Write a short dialogue (8-10 lines) between two people discussing how their habits used to be different before a difficult period in their lives.
4. Write 3 'compare and contrast' sentences using the past simple, the past continuous, and 'used to' about the same event.

Vocabulary

1. Choose the correct meaning of 'resilient'.
 - a. weak
 - b. able to recover quickly from difficulty
 - c. wealthy
 - d. forgetful
2. Her parents made a lot of _____ so she could study abroad. (give up something important)
3. Which word best completes: 'Losing his job was a big _____ for the family.'
 - a. achievement
 - b. obstacle
 - c. opportunity
 - d. support

Grammar

1. They _____ (not have) enough food during the hardest winter.
2. Choose the correct sentence.
 - a. While she was cooking, the phone was ringing suddenly.
 - b. While she was cooking, the phone rang.
 - c. While she cooked, the phone was ringing.
 - d. While she was cook, the phone rang.
3. He _____ (walk) to school every day when he was a child.
4. She didn't used to like vegetables. — *True / False*

Reading

1. In 'From the Repair Shop to the Stage', what was Kerem's family business?
 - a. A café
 - b. A bicycle repair shop
 - c. A music school
 - d. A bookshop
2. Kerem taught himself guitar using an old _____ his uncle gave him.

Listening

1. What did speaker A do while other students went home?

AbOnlineEnglish Upper Secondary — 11. Sınıf — Complete Theme · Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.

- ☐ a. Went home too
- ☐ b. Stayed late for extra help
- ☐ c. Played sports
- ☐ d. Worked in a shop